

BUDGET COMMITTEE MEETING - Wednesday August 26, 2026

2:00 p.m.

Budget Committee: Ron Smith, Colene Martin, Gary Richardson, Marc Kirby, Chris Collins and Dorothy Yetter; Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Budget Officer: Matthew Eide

Open Meeting - Gary Richardson, Budget Committee Chair

Chair Richardson opened the meeting at 2:00 p.m. Chair Smith led the Pledge of Allegiance.

Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

Members Yetter, Collins, Martin, Smith, Kirby, and Richardson each declared no potential conflicts of interest.

Supplemental Budget - Additional Staffing Needs for FY 2026-2027

Budget Officer and Finance Director Matthew Eide presented a supplemental staffing package totaling 6.5 additional full-time-equivalent positions across several County funds. He explained that departments had been asked to identify either a significant omission from the adopted budget or materially new circumstances or funding that arose after adoption.

The requests consisted of: a WIC dietitian in Public Health supported by new grant funding; one Solid Waste support position funded through Solid Waste franchise revenue; one Building and Safety code-enforcement position supported through departmental fees; one Community Corrections parole/probation position funded through reallocation within that department; two Internal Services positions, one focused on Finance audit work and one Human Resources Analyst; and a half-time Veterans Affairs support position. The new authorized expenditure associated with the package totaled \$596,000, exclusive of the Community Corrections FTE that would be funded through an existing departmental reallocation.

The Committee discussed whether some requests had previously been considered during adoption of the original budget, the distinction between Building and Safety code enforcement and Solid Waste enforcement, the source of funding for each position, and the effect of the new WIC grant. Mr. Eide explained that the full Public Health grant is approximately \$398,000, with \$107,000 allocated to the proposed dietitian position.

Substantial discussion occurred regarding County reserves, contingencies, current vacancies, and recently negotiated collective bargaining agreements. Committee members questioned whether compensation increases could reduce the number of FTEs the County is able to fill within previously approved appropriations and discussed the importance of ensuring that budgeted FTE counts accurately reflect positions the County can actually staff. Mr. Eide stated that approximately forty or more positions were vacant at the time and that roughly twenty were then posted, although some postings represented multiple vacancies.

The Committee also discussed law-enforcement staffing funded through voter-approved taxes, the distinction between authorized FTE and cash appropriations, and whether vacant positions should be reduced to offset compensation changes. Members expressed differing views on whether reductions should occur immediately or whether departments should be given time to recruit and manage vacancies and turnover. Finance agreed to continue analyzing the financial effect of completed collective bargaining agreements and to provide updated information as the actual costs are finalized.

Mr. Eide reviewed fund-level impacts. He stated that the General Fund request presented that day was approximately \$40,000 for the half-time Veterans Affairs position, while the other requests were supported through Public Health grant funds, Solid Waste funds, Building and Safety funds, Internal Services, or Community Corrections. Committee members also discussed the approximately \$1.2 million operating contingency in Fund 10, restricted or dedicated reserves in other funds, and the need to distinguish available General Fund resources from funds legally limited to specific purposes.

Supplemental Budget Motions

Public Health: Dorothy Yetter made a motion to authorize an additional \$107,000 in the FY 2026-2027 budget and add 1.0 FTE. Seconded by Colene Martin. Upon roll call: Yetter - Yes; Collins - No; Martin - Yes; Smith - Yes; Kirby - No; Richardson - Yes. Motion carried 4-2.

Solid Waste: Ron Smith made a motion to authorize an additional \$93,000 in the FY 2026-2027 budget and add 1.0 FTE. Seconded by Colene Martin. Upon roll call: Yetter - Yes; Collins - No; Martin - Yes; Smith - Yes; Kirby - No; Richardson - Yes. Motion carried 4-2.

Building and Safety: Dorothy Yetter made a motion to authorize an additional \$101,000 in the FY 2026-2027 budget and add 1.0 FTE. Seconded by Ron Smith. Upon roll call: Yetter - Yes; Collins - No; Martin - Yes; Smith - Yes; Kirby - No; Richardson - Yes. Motion carried 4-2.

Internal Services: Colene Martin made a motion to authorize an additional \$255,000 in the FY 2026-2027 budget and add 2.0 FTE. Seconded by Marc Kirby. Upon roll call: Yetter - Yes; Collins - No; Martin - Yes; Smith - Yes; Kirby - No; Richardson - Yes. Motion carried 4-2.

General Fund / Veterans Affairs: Ron Smith made a motion to authorize an additional \$40,000 in the FY 2026-2027 budget and add 0.5 FTE. Seconded by Marc Kirby. Upon roll call: Yetter - Yes; Collins - No; Martin - Yes; Smith - Yes; Kirby - No; Richardson - Yes. Motion carried 4-2.

Community Corrections: Dorothy Yetter made a motion to add 1.0 FTE within Community Corrections. Seconded by Ron Smith. Upon roll call: Yetter - Yes; Collins - No; Martin - Yes; Smith - Yes; Kirby - No; Richardson - Yes. Motion carried 4-2.

Approval of Minutes

Colene Martin made a motion to delegate approval of the minutes of this Budget Committee meeting to the Board of County Commissioners. Seconded by Ron Smith. Upon roll call: Yetter - Yes; Collins - Yes; Martin - Yes; Smith - Yes; Kirby - Yes; Richardson - Yes. Motion carried 6-0.

Other / Announcements

Chair Richardson reminded County employees that the OEBB benefits enrollment period was underway and encouraged departments to complete enrollment by August 31, 2026. Current departmental completion percentages were displayed for the Committee.

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 3:03 p.m.